U.S. Semiconductors

PC Pulse: October 2026 – Supply Tightness Likely Carries Into CY27

September miss and tightness expected into Q4. Component cost pressures should remain elevated through CY27.

September missed despite some above seasonal performance typical in the final month of the quarter. Commentary on Q4 continues to be cautious with no signs of improvement on both demand and supply. Q4 guides imply total ODMs down ~L-MSD% Q/Q vs. normal seasonality down LSD%. Our full year numbers are roughly unchanged at 108.7M (-16% Y/Y) vs. 108.8M prior. We currently model INTC/AMD at -2% Q/Q and -9% Q/Q in Q4 vs. the ODMs -5%. Looking into CY27, we now estimate -4% Y/Y vs. -2% prior as commentary around memory supply/demand sounds just as constrained if not worse.

NB ODMs Miss in September: September NB came in below at 9.7M (+32% M/M vs. our estimate of 9.8M) with 3 out of 5 ODMs coming in below and most pointing to weaker conditions into Q4. We model Q4 down 5% in aggregate vs. normal seasonal down 3% Q/Q. Our full-year forecast for CY26 moves just slightly lower to 108.7M (-16% Y/Y), vs. 108.8M prior. For CY27, we expect 4% declines and our numbers move to 104.6M from 106.5M (revised 2% lower).

FIGURE 1. Monthly Results & Changes to Estimates Summary (units in 000s)

September Monthly Results & Updated October and Quarterly Estimates								
Taiwanese ODMs	September Actual	Barclays Prior Est.	October Estimate	Barclays Prior Est.	3Q26 Actual	Barclays Prior Est.	4Q26 Forecast	Barclays Prior Est.
Top 5 NB ODM	9,660	9,750	7,200	7,600	25,185	25,275	23,875	23,860
MoM; QoQ	*+32%*	*+33%*	*-25%*	*-22%*	*-17%*	*-17%*	*-5%*	*-6%*

Source: Company Reports and Barclays Research estimates

DRAM Continues Move Higher While NAND Contract Continues to Roll: DDR4 8Gb 1Gx8 spot was +4% M/M (+22% over the last 3mo), with contract +4% M/M (+24% over the last 3mo). DDR5 16G (2Gx8) 4800/5600 spot was +8% M/M (+23% over the last 3mo), with contract +3% M/M (+20% over the last 3mo). The price discount between DDR5 modules relative to DDR4 counterparts widened to 10% in September, up from 6% in 2Q26. MU's most recent earnings highlighted that supply would be even tighter in CY27/28 than previously expected and new SCAs are more weighted to market pricing dynamics, as opposed to the floor/ceiling prices of CQ2. Concerns around de-speccing have been an overhang to memory stocks in recent months but we believe this is an intermediate solution to limited supply and customers would ultimately prefer more performant solutions with higher levels of memory content as MU mgmt. noted this has created a "latent demand dynamic". For MU, we model FQ1 DRAM ASP +7% Q/Q (vs. St. +8% Q/Q). For NAND, 128GB MLC spot was +2% M/M (+16% over the last 3mo), with contract flat M/M (+6% over the last 3mo). SNDK has stated that bit growth was likely to fall on the low end of their FY27 forecast of M-HT% Y/Y as the company needs to build an inventory

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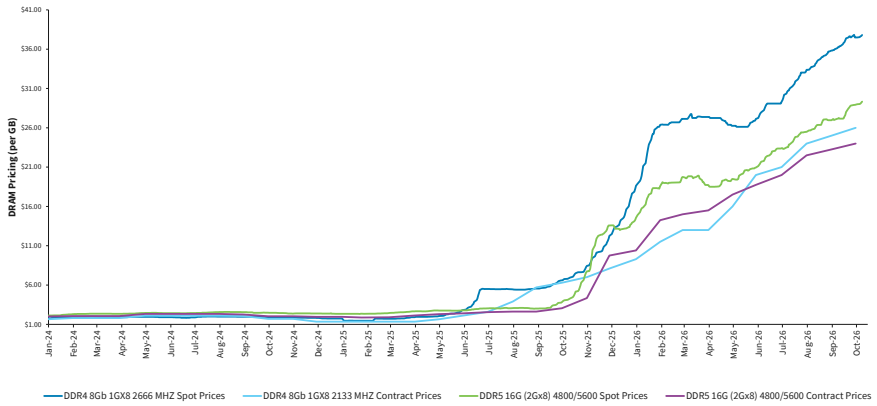
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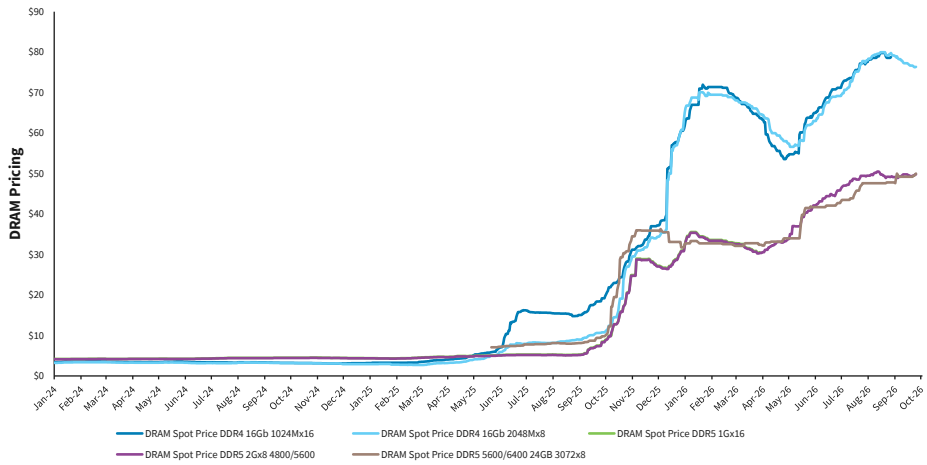
buffer to service new contracts. We suspect this dynamic may continue to play out as a greater % of bits fall under NBMs moving forward and take pricing higher. We note that of late contract pricing is not a good reflection of long term deals which continue to push higher and are focused on the largest customers in the market. For MU, we model FQ1 Flash ASP +8% Q/Q (vs. St. at 9% Q/Q).

FIGURE 2. DRAM Spot vs. Contract Pricing



Source: DRAMeXchange and Barclays Research

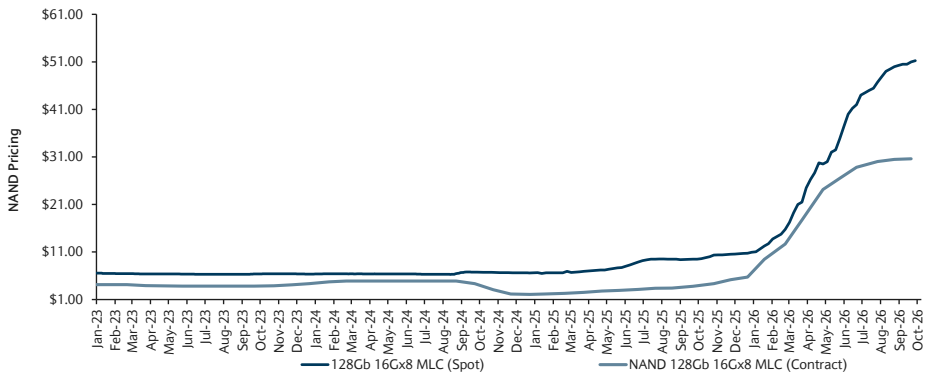
FIGURE 3. DRAM Spot Pricing



Source: Bloomberg

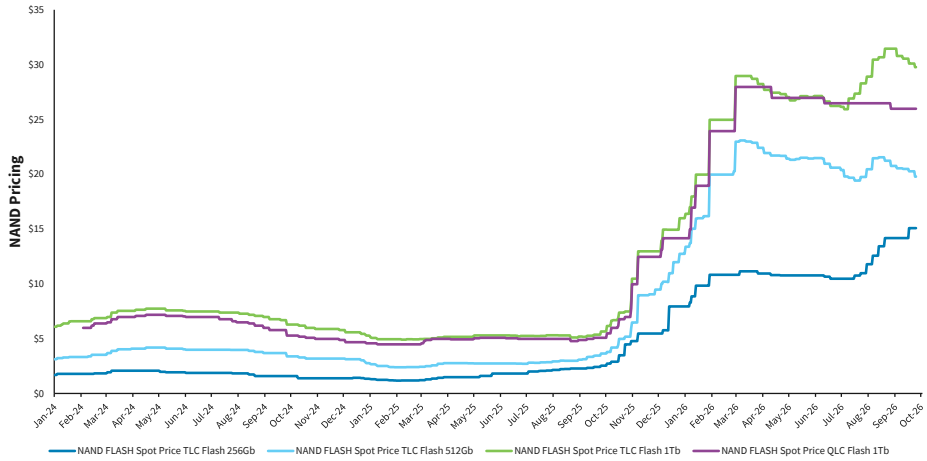
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FIGURE 4. NAND Spot vs. Contract Pricing



Source: DRAMeXchange and Barclays Research

FIGURE 5. NAND Spot Pricing



Source: Bloomberg

HPQ, DELL, AAPL. September monthly unit numbers from notebook ODMs in Taiwan have shown some tick-up sequentially, with top 5 ODMs increasing 32% MoM, though still down 20% on a year-over-year basis. In the prior June-quarter and 1H of this year, we have seen some pull forwards that helped lift up the shipments in that period. However, as we move into Q3 and the back half, the pull-in effect is largely gone and we are starting to see the demand falling off. In the prior June-Q, top 5 ODMs shipments had MSD increase sequentially and HSD decline Y/Y, while in Q3 top 5 ODM shipments were down 17% Q/Q and 26% Y/Y, well below historical seasonality. Most players expect continued soft demand in Q4 and guided to HSD to DD % sequential decline in Q4 and DD% y/y decline for 2026. We took down our PC unit forecast further in September and now model a low DD% decline in 2026 and LSD% decline in 2027.

Asia ODMs have seen motherboard shipments decline 45% Y/Y and down 12% M/M in the last month of our complete data (September). Microstar guided October to be single-digits % decline sequentially from September. The y/y declines began in December last year (tough comps) and have accelerated every month since. September data ended Q3 motherboard shipments for the top 4 Taiwanese ODMs to decline LSD Q/Q and 39% Y/Y.

Recall, notebook shipments from the top 5 Taiwanese ODMs (Quanta, Compal, Wistron, Inventec, Pegatron) were down 8% y/y in Q2, which was below typical seasonality. We believe pull-ins are driving some of the expected 1H stability across the industry, as customers look to

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secure supply, as well as AI PC mix. However, we don't believe AI PC mix will be enough to prevent potential further downward bias to our overall unit estimates for the year. And now heading into 2H, we are starting to see softer demand from the customers in light of the higher prices, and we think as the customers adjust their shipment for the full year with a more conservative outlook, we will likely see demand erosion in 2H as a result. We also believe the majority of the Windows 11 refresh cycle is now over, and the remaining installed base will see a much slower refresh rate.

Commercial PC demand remains stronger than consumer, though we could see a scenario in which IT budgets are prioritized for areas higher up on the tech stack that are also seeing ASP increases from commodities (i.e. servers, networking, storage) with PCs de-prioritized in the annual budget. However, we do believe the pass-through of memory costs much easier in Commercial, which could heighten the delta between the commercial and consumer demand. Higher ASPs and de-specing have all been mentioned as mitigation efforts to offset the higher commodity costs, though we expect pricing actions could temper volumes/overall demand. We are UW HPQ, given the concerns mentioned above and OW DELL, given their upsized AI server revenue expectations, strong execution, stabilized AI business model and disciplined opex management.

AI PC commentary continues to be positive with higher AI PC mix as well as higher premium products mix, which we expect to boost ASP growth somewhat. As per HPQ's Q3FY26 update, AI PCs made up 46% of the company's PC shipments, up from 44% the Q prior, with FY27 AI PC mix guide of 60-70% and FY28 >70% outlook unchanged. HPQ had two price increases last year – one after initial impact for tariffs and the other after the August increase in tariffs (as well as typical annual increases). However, we expect further pricing to move through the business this year and the pull-in activities in 1H pressure on 2H results and margins. Our AAPL Mac unit expectations for CY26 are up DD for the year with Sept-Q revenues up DD y/y. With the low-cost Mac Neo product line gaining traction and given AAPL's supply chain, we think there could be a world where we see upside to mac units for the year, if AAPL is able to secure supply at a more favorable rate than competitors. However, overall, given the commodity environment and decelerating Win11 refresh cycle, we expect PC weakness through the year, with LSD unit decline into CY27.

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FIGURE 6. Top Five Taiwanese NB ODM Monthly Shipments (Ks of Units)

Top Five Taiwanese NB ODM Monthly Shipments (Ks of Units)	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26	Jun-26	Jul-26	Aug-26	Sep-26	E Oct-26	E Nov-26	E Dec-26
Quanta																								
Shipment	2,800	3,100	4,900	3,300	3,800	5,000	4,000	4,100	4,600	3,500	3,500	3,900	2,700	2,000	5,300	3,500	3,500	4,500	2,800	2,600	4,200	2,500	3,075	3,400
MoM/QoQ %	(35%)	11%	58%	(33%)	15%	32%	(20%)	2%	12%	(24%)	0%	11%	(31%)	(26%)	165%	(34%)	0%	29%	(38%)	(7%)	62%	(40%)	23%	11%
Historical Seasonality	(20%)	(7%)	46%	(36%)	26%	21%	(16%)	14%	7%	(31%)	15%	6%	(28%)	4%	56%	(31%)	22%	22%	(23%)	17%	9%	(32%)	15%	9%
YoY %	(3%)	7%	4%	3%	(5%)	11%	18%	(5%)	(6%)	9%	(3%)	(9%)	(4%)	(35%)	8%	6%	(8%)	(10%)	(30%)	(37%)	(9%)	(29%)	(12%)	(13%)
Compal																								
Shipment	2,000	2,100	2,900	2,200	2,400	2,500	2,300	2,300	2,500	2,100	2,300	2,400	1,600	1,500	2,800	1,800	2,000	2,400	1,800	1,400	1,700	1,600	1,825	1,700
MoM/QoQ %	(13%)	5%	38%	(24%)	9%	4%	(8%)	0%	9%	(16%)	10%	4%	(33%)	(6%)	87%	(36%)	11%	20%	(25%)	(22%)	21%	(6%)	14%	(7%)
Historical Seasonality	(21%)	3%	36%	(29%)	26%	21%	(16%)	(5%)	6%	(5%)	(7%)	(8%)	(14%)	5%	40%	(19%)	13%	6%	(8%)	1%	5%	(9%)	2%	(8%)
YoY %	(9%)	(9%)	(3%)	(21%)	(17%)	(17%)	(8%)	(21%)	(14%)	(25%)	(15%)	4%	(20%)	(29%)	(3%)	(18%)	(17%)	(4%)	(22%)	(39%)	(32%)	(24%)	(21%)	(29%)
Wistron																								
Shipment	1,500	1,500	1,900	1,700	1,800	2,400	2,000	2,200	2,200	2,100	2,200	2,600	1,700	1,600	2,800	1,800	1,700	2,000	1,600	1,400	1,500	1,300	1,350	1,400
MoM/QoQ %	(17%)	0%	27%	(11%)	6%	33%	(17%)	10%	0%	(5%)	5%	18%	(35%)	(6%)	75%	(36%)	(6%)	18%	(20%)	(13%)	7%	(13%)	4%	4%
Historical Seasonality	(32%)	4%	38%	(20%)	11%	13%	(16%)	3%	21%	(15%)	0%	4%	(25%)	6%	32%	(13%)	6%	18%	(13%)	10%	10%	(8%)	2%	8%
YoY %	15%	7%	0%	6%	6%	33%	25%	29%	16%	17%	29%	44%	13%	7%	47%	6%	(6%)	(17%)	(20%)	(36%)	(32%)	(38%)	(39%)	(46%)
Inventec																								
Shipment	1,500	1,600	1,900	1,700	1,800	2,100	1,700	1,800	1,900	1,600	1,700	2,000	1,700	1,500	2,200	1,500	1,500	2,500	1,600	1,500	1,800	1,400	1,450	1,575
MoM/QoQ %	(25%)	7%	19%	(11%)	6%	17%	(19%)	6%	6%	(16%)	6%	18%	(15%)	(12%)	47%	(32%)	0%	67%	(36%)	(6%)	20%	(22%)	4%	9%
Historical Seasonality	(6%)	(4%)	26%	(11%)	12%	2%	(7%)	1%	8%	(11%)	1%	4%	(8%)	(2%)	21%	(12%)	16%	4%	(10%)	5%	7%	(15%)	7%	10%
YoY %	0%	23%	12%	13%	6%	24%	0%	4%	6%	(6%)	0%	0%	13%	(6%)	16%	(12%)	(17%)	19%	(6%)	(17%)	(5%)	(13%)	(15%)	(21%)
Pegatron																								
Shipment	610	575	700	610	775	990	750	825	825	775	710	925	700	425	675	525	575	650	400	425	460	400	425	475
MoM/QoQ %	(19%)	(6%)	22%	(13%)	27%	28%	(24%)	10%	0%	(6%)	(8%)	30%	(24%)	(39%)	59%	(22%)	10%	13%	(38%)	6%	8%	(13%)	6%	12%
Historical Seasonality	(15%)	(3%)	64%	(28%)	17%	18%	(6%)	7%	5%	(34%)	12%	(2%)	(14%)	4%	45%	(19%)	28%	19%	(12%)	16%	(3%)	(24%)	0%	12%
YoY %	16%	53%	8%	16%	6%	28%	(3%)	(6%)	0%	35%	14%	23%	15%	(26%)	(4%)	(14%)	(26%)	(34%)	(47%)	(48%)	(44%)	(48%)	(40%)	(49%)
Top 5																								
Shipment	**8,410**	**8,875**	**12,300**	**9,510**	**10,575**	**12,990**	**10,750**	**11,225**	**12,025**	**10,075**	**10,410**	**11,825**	**8,400**	**7,025**	**13,775**	**9,125**	**9,275**	**12,050**	**8,200**	**7,325**	**9,660**	**7,200**	**8,125**	**8,550**
MoM/QoQ %	**(25%)**	**6%**	**39%**	**(23%)**	**11%**	**23%**	**(17%)**	**4%**	**7%**	**(16%)**	**3%**	**14%**	**(29%)**	**(16%)**	**96%**	**(34%)**	**2%**	**30%**	**(32%)**	**(11%)**	**32%**	**(25%)**	**13%**	**5%**
Historical Seasonality	(21%)	(3%)	39%	(28%)	20%	17%	(15%)	4%	8%	(20%)	4%	1%	(21%)	3%	41%	(22%)	16%	14%	(16%)	9%	7%	(20%)	6%	5%
YoY %	**(0%)**	**7%**	**3%**	**(1%)**	**(4%)**	**10%**	**8%**	**(2%)**	**(2%)**	**0%**	**1%**	**6%**	**(0%)**	**(21%)**	**12%**	**(4%)**	**(12%)**	**(7%)**	**(24%)**	**(35%)**	**(20%)**	**(29%)**	**(22%)**	**(28%)**

Quanta, Compal, Wistron, Inventec and Pegatron are not covered by Barclays Research
Source: Company Reports and Barclays Research

FIGURE 7. Top Five Taiwanese NB ODM Quarterly Shipments (Ks of Units)

Top Five Taiwanese NB ODM Quarterly Shipments (Ks of Units)	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	E 4Q26	E 1Q27	E 2Q27	E 3Q27	E 4Q27	2024	2025	E 2026	E 2027
Quanta																				
Shipment	10,500	11,700	12,600	11,100	10,800	12,100	12,700	10,900	10,000	11,500	9,600	8,975	8,437	9,702	10,284	9,564	45,900	46,500	40,075	37,987
MoM/QoQ %	1%	11%	8%	(12%)	(3%)	12%	5%	(14%)	(8%)	15%	(17%)	(7%)	(6%)	15%	6%	(7%)				
Historical Seasonality	(18%)	16%	6%	(3%)	(15%)	13%	8%	(3%)	(15%)	12%	6%	(7%)	(12%)	14%	5%	(9%)				
YoY %	(3%)	(7%)	(4%)	7%	3%	3%	1%	(2%)	(7%)	(5%)	(24%)	(18%)	(16%)	(16%)	7%	7%	(2%)	1%	(14%)	(5%)
Compal																				
Shipment	7,500	8,700	8,300	7,800	7,000	7,100	7,100	6,800	5,900	6,200	4,900	5,125	4,869	5,648	5,817	5,992	32,300	28,000	22,125	22,325
MoM/QoQ %	(10%)	16%	(5%)	(6%)	(10%)	1%	0%	(4%)	(13%)	5%	(21%)	5%	(5%)	16%	3%	3%				
Historical Seasonality	(18%)	10%	4%	(1%)	(15%)	15%	(1%)	(4%)	(14%)	15%	(2%)	(5%)	(12%)	10%	(6%)	(5%)				
YoY %	(1%)	0%	(11%)	(6%)	(7%)	(18%)	(14%)	(13%)	(16%)	(13%)	(31%)	(25%)	(17%)	(9%)	19%	17%	(5%)	(13%)	(21%)	1%
Wistron																				
Shipment	4,600	5,100	5,200	5,300	4,900	5,900	6,400	6,900	6,100	5,500	4,500	4,050	3,848	4,502	5,042	5,647	20,200	24,100	20,150	19,038
MoM/QoQ %	(13%)	11%	2%	2%	(8%)	20%	8%	8%	(12%)	(10%)	(18%)	(10%)	(5%)	17%	12%	12%				
Historical Seasonality	(20%)	15%	8%	3%	(18%)	12%	5%	2%	(15%)	15%	8%	5%	(15%)	15%	5%	5%				
YoY %	18%	11%	0%	0%	7%	16%	23%	30%	24%	(7%)	(30%)	(41%)	(37%)	(18%)	12%	39%	6%	19%	(16%)	(6%)
Inventec																				
Shipment	4,500	4,900	5,225	5,400	5,000	5,600	5,400	5,300	5,400	5,500	4,900	4,425	4,160	4,575	4,804	4,804	20,025	21,300	20,225	18,343
MoM/QoQ %	0%	9%	7%	3%	(7%)	12%	(4%)	(2%)	2%	2%	(11%)	(10%)	(6%)	10%	5%	0%				
Historical Seasonality	(13%)	10%	2%	(6%)	(12%)	10%	2%	(6%)	(9%)	12%	0%	(6%)	(8%)	10%	0%	(7%)				
YoY %	2%	0%	7%	20%	11%	14%	3%	(2%)	8%	(2%)	(9%)	(17%)	(23%)	(17%)	(2%)	9%	7%	6%	(5%)	(9%)
Pegatron																				
Shipment	1,550	2,030	2,475	1,950	1,885	2,375	2,400	2,410	1,800	1,750	1,285	1,300	1,235	1,791	1,970	1,911	8,005	9,070	6,135	6,906
MoM/QoQ %	(6%)	31%	22%	(21%)	(3%)	26%	1%	0%	(25%)	(3%)	(27%)	1%	(5%)	45%	10%	(3%)				
Historical Seasonality	(24%)	(4%)	12%	16%	(21%)	14%	14%	0%	(18%)	24%	12%	(7%)	(18%)	24%	8%	(7%)				
YoY %	(9%)	(2%)	(1%)	18%	22%	17%	(3%)	24%	(5%)	(26%)	(46%)	(46%)	(31%)	2%	53%	47%	1%	13%	(32%)	13%
Top 5																				
Shipment	**28,650**	**32,430**	**33,800**	**31,550**	**29,585**	**33,075**	**34,000**	**32,310**	**29,200**	**30,450**	**25,185**	**23,875**	**22,547**	**26,218**	**27,917**	**27,918**	**126,430**	**128,970**	**108,710**	**104,599**
MoM/QoQ %	**(5%)**	**13%**	**4%**	**(7%)**	**(6%)**	**12%**	**3%**	**(5%)**	**(10%)**	**4%**	**(17%)**	**(5%)**	**(6%)**	**16%**	**6%**	**0%**				
Historical Seasonality	(17%)	10%	6%	1%	(16%)	11%	6%	(1%)	(14%)	12%	5%	(3%)	(10%)	12%	4%	(5%)				
YoY %	**1%**	**(1%)**	**(3%)**	**5%**	**3%**	**2%**	**1%**	**2%**	**(1%)**	**(8%)**	**(26%)**	**(26%)**	**(23%)**	**(14%)**	**11%**	**17%**	**0%**	**2%**	**(16%)**	**(4%)**

Quanta, Compal, Wistron, Inventec and Pegatron are not covered by Barclays Research
Source: Company Reports and Barclays Research

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Apple, Inc. (AAPL, 08-Oct-2026, USD 340.42), Underweight/Neutral, CD/CE/D/J/K/L/M/N

Dell Technologies Inc. (DELL, 08-Oct-2026, USD 574.55), Overweight/Neutral, A/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

HP Inc. (HPQ, 08-Oct-2026, USD 32.44), Underweight/Neutral, CD/CE/E/J/K/L/M/N

Intel Corp. (INTC, 08-Oct-2026, USD 107.08), Equal Weight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/J/K/L/M/N

Micron Technology, Inc. (MU, 08-Oct-2026, USD 1035.84), Overweight/Neutral, CD/CE/FA/J/K/M/N

Sandisk Corporation (SNDK, 08-Oct-2026, USD 1609.46), Overweight/Neutral, A/D/J/L

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Corning Incorporated (GLW)	Corsair Gaming, Inc. (CRSR)	Dell Technologies Inc. (DELL)
Everpure, Inc. (P)	F5, Inc. (FFIV)	Fabrinet (FN)
Flex Ltd (FLEX)	Garmin (GRMN)	Harmonic, Inc. (HLIT)
Hewlett Packard Enterprise Company (HPE)	HP Inc. (HPQ)	Jabil (JBL)
Keysight Technologies, Inc. (KEYS)	Logitech (LOGI)	Motorola Solutions, Inc. (MSI)
NetApp, Inc. (NTAP)	Nutanix, Inc (NTNX)	Super Micro (SMCI)
Ubiquiti, Inc. (UI)		

U.S. Semiconductors & Semiconductor Capital Equipment

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Broadcom Inc. (AVGO)	Camtek (CAMT)	Cerebras Systems Inc. (CBRS)
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Intel Corp. (INTC)	KLA Corporation (KLAC)	Lam Research Corporation (LRCX)
Lumentum Holdings Inc. (LITE)	MACOM Technology Solutions Holdings, Inc. (MTSI)	Marvell Technology Group, Ltd. (MRVL)
Microchip Technology (MCHP)	Micron Technology, Inc. (MU)	Nova Limited (NVMI)
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